

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Christopher Zorn

August 24, 2026

From the course description:

...Students will unpack how human-generated data is collected, structured, and transformed into machine learning models, discovering both the technical and human sides of AI. Through real-world case studies, interactive projects, and critical discussions, students will gain hands-on experience with data systems and analytics tools while examining the social, political, and ethical questions that surround AI in practice.

Course attributes:

- PLSC B.A. majors can use this course toward the 100-level-or-above requirement and the requirement for any political science or related area.
- PLSC (B.A. or B.S.) majors can receive GS credit if they register for the course as SODA 110N, since PLSC majors must take GS credits outside of the discipline of political science.
- SoDA majors can use this course toward the requirement of six credits of additional political science.

Various things:

- Course meetings: Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays 1:25-2:15 p.m. ET.
- Location is [Health and Human Development Building](#), Room 350
- No classes on September 7 (Labor Day), September 11, October 16, or November 23-27 (Thanksgiving break)
- Course materials: <https://github.com/PrisonRodeo/PLSC197-FA2026-git>

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[📖 README](#)

PLSC197 / SoDA 197N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

This is the github repository for the Fall 2026 version of PLSC 197 / SoDA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence. This site contains all relevant course materials for the class.

About

[Github repository for PLSC 197 / SODA 110N - Fall 2026](#)

- 📖 Readme
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Releases

No releases published
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Contributors 1

 PrisonRodeo Christopher Zorn

Languages



Grades will be based upon:

- Course attendance / participation: 100 points
- Two (of $\approx$ twelve possible) short assignments: 100 points each
- Two applied labs: 150 points each
- Final examination: 400 points

Other things:

- The grading scale is [here](#).

Find me at:

- E-mail: zorn@psu.edu
- (Non-virtual) Office: 545 Susan Welch Building
- Office Hours: By appointment
- Zoom: <https://psu.zoom.us/my/prisonrodeo>
- Mobile Phone / Text: 803-553-4077
- Bluesky (rarely): [@prisonrodeo](#)

Things To Do Before Wednesday

1. Bookmark: <https://github.com/PrisonRodeo/PLSC197-FA2026-git/>
2. Read the following:
 - Mimi Onuoha. “The Point of Collection.” *Data & Society*, February 2016.
 - Nicola Jones. “The AI Revolution is Running Out of Data. What Can Researchers Do?” *Nature*, 636(8042):290-292, December 2024.

(both are available in the “Readings” folder on the Github repo)